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ARTICLE

A Dangerous Trend: Why Support For Israel Is Fading In America

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BY PNW STAFF MARCH 17, 2026

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The numbers are sobering, and for many Christians who have long viewed support for Israel as both a moral and biblical conviction, they are deeply troubling.

In the months following the Hamas terrorist attacks of October 7, 2023, there was an immediate surge of sympathy for Israel across the United States. Americans watched in horror as terrorists murdered civilians, kidnapped families, and unleashed the worst massacre of Jews since the Holocaust. For a brief moment, the moral clarity seemed obvious.

But that moment has faded.

Today, new polling suggests that American attitudes toward Israel are undergoing a historic transformation--and the shift is being driven largely by younger voters, Democrats, and independents.

According to recent polling from Gallup, Americans are now slightly more likely to sympathize with Palestinians than with Israelis--41% to 36%--marking the first time in more than two decades of polling that Israel has trailed in overall sympathy.

For decades, Israel consistently enjoyed a strong advantage in American public opinion. That era may now be ending.

Jesus-centered devotionals
Christian apologetics books

A Dramatic Collapse Among Democrats

The most dramatic change has taken place inside the Democratic Party.

Polling from Pew Research Center shows that negative views of Israel among Americans have risen significantly in recent years, with 53% of Americans now holding an unfavorable opinion of Israel, up from 42% just three years earlier.

But the numbers inside the Democratic Party are even more striking.

Among Democrats, 69% now view Israel unfavorably, compared with 53% only a few years ago.

The divide between Republicans and Democrats on Israel has become one of the largest partisan gaps in foreign policy polling.

Meanwhile, Democrats are increasingly sympathetic toward Palestinians by overwhelming margins, with surveys showing Democrats siding with Palestinians over Israelis by nearly three-to-one in some polling.

This shift is not simply a reaction to a single war. It reflects a broader ideological change that has been building for years within progressive politics.

In many activist circles today, Israel is framed not as a democratic ally but as a "settler colonial state," an accusation that has spread through campus activism, academic institutions, and political advocacy groups.

The Generational Divide

If the partisan divide is stark, the generational divide is even more dramatic.

Younger Americans now hold views toward Israel that are radically different from older generations.

A Gallup survey found that 53% of Americans ages 18-34 now sympathize more with Palestinians, compared with only 23% who sympathize more with Israelis.

By contrast, older Americans remain strongly supportive of Israel.

Among Americans over 55, roughly half still sympathize more with Israel than with Palestinians.

This is not a minor demographic difference--it represents a fundamental generational realignment.

And because younger voters eventually become the dominant electorate, the long-term implications are profound.

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The Power of Social Media Narratives

One major factor driving this shift is the transformation of the information ecosystem.

Younger Americans increasingly get their news from short-form social media platforms such as TikTok, Instagram, and YouTube.

These platforms tend to amplify emotionally powerful content--particularly images of war, destruction, and civilian suffering.

In the context of the Gaza war, this environment has created an overwhelming stream of content portraying Israel primarily through images of devastation, often with little historical context about Hamas terrorism, Israeli security threats, or the complexities of the conflict.

For many young viewers, this content becomes their primary understanding of the Middle East.

And once those narratives take root, they are reinforced by activist influencers who command millions of followers online.

Universities and Cultural Institutions

Universities have also played a major role in shaping younger Americans' views.

Since October 7, campuses across the United States have seen:

pro-Palestinian encampments

anti-Israel protests

faculty activism

divestment campaigns

While the participants represent a small percentage of the population, the cultural influence of universities remains enormous.

Ideas that once existed primarily in academic theory--such as framing Israel through "colonialism" narratives--are now widespread among younger political activists.

New Anti-Israel Voices on the Right

While most of the decline in support for Israel has come from the political left, there are also emerging shifts on the right.

Some influential commentators have begun criticizing Israel or questioning America's alliance with the country.

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The End of the Bipartisan Consensus

For most of the past half-century, support for Israel was one of the rare issues in Washington that enjoyed bipartisan agreement.

Democrats and Republicans alike viewed Israel as:

a democratic ally

a strategic partner

a nation fighting terrorism in a dangerous region

That consensus is now fracturing.

Polling consistently shows that American views on Israel are increasingly divided by party, ideology, and age.

And once foreign policy becomes deeply polarized, restoring consensus becomes far more difficult.

A Warning for Christians

For many Christians, support for Israel is not merely geopolitical--it is also spiritual.

Scripture repeatedly affirms the enduring significance of the Jewish people and the land of Israel in God's unfolding plan for history.

Yet as American culture becomes increasingly secular, biblical literacy continues to decline.

Many younger Americans are now forming opinions about Israel without any understanding of:

the historical Jewish connection to the land

the security threats Israel faces

or the biblical roots that have shaped Western support for the Jewish state.

The result is a cultural environment where misinformation spreads easily and historical memory fades quickly.

The Moment for Clarity

None of this means support for Israel in America is disappearing overnight.

Older Americans, evangelical Christians, and many conservatives remain strongly supportive of Israel.

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In an age of confusion, misinformation, and cultural hostility, silence is not an option.

Truth must be spoken.

History must be remembered.

And the moral clarity that briefly emerged on October 7 must not be allowed to disappear.

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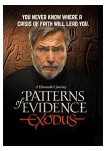

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